Frieze

From the complex of Sultan Qalawun (683-84 AH / 1284-85 CE)

Obverse: late Ayyubid or early Bahri periods, 7th-8th centuries AH / mid-13th-14th centuries CE Reverse: Fatimid period, c. 450 AH / 1058 CE

Wood

W: 223 cm; H: 35.5 cm

Inv. no. 3196





Long wooden frieze, recovered from the complex of Sultan Qalawun (683-84 AH / 1284-85 CE). The reverse, dated to the Fatimid period and likely displayed in the Fatimid Lesser (Western) Palace that once occupied the site, features relief-carved human and animal figures set within geometric frames with infills of scrolling arabesques; the figures are rendered primarily in outline, suggesting that their finer details were originally completed in paint. The obverse bears markedly finer decoration of large vine scrolls enclosing lobed leaves, pomegranates or grapes, and chalices, all characteristic of Umayyad-revival art in the late Ayyubid and early Mamluk periods.

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